



Frontrunners: In sprints, 200m winners — Animesh Kujur and Unnathi Aiyappa Bolland (in pic, left) — showed great potential and are bright prospects for the future. PTI

NATIONAL RECORD-HOLDER JESWIN ALDRIN COULD ONLY PRODUCE 7.99M ON HIS WAY TO THE GOLD MEDAL DESPITE PLEASANT CONDITIONS

Veerpal Kaur (59.43s) emerged as the winner.

Abha Khatua claimed sole ownership of the National Record in women's shot put on the second day. Abha, who equalled Manpreet's Kaur effort of 18.06m in Asian Championships in July last year, went past it with a throw of 18.41m in the fifth round. **The 28-year-old, who switched from gliding to rotation technique in 2022, is still well short of the automatic qualification mark of 18.80m for the Paris Olympics.**

A day later, Asian Record-holder

Tajinderpal Singh Toor took the gold in men's event with 20.38m, well below his personal best of 21.77m set at the same competition last year in June.

Toor, who recorded four foul throws, said he has some fitness issues due to which he will not go for competitions outside India but is confident of achieving the 21.50m mark required to qualify for Olympics at the National Inter-State Championships.

The jumpers failed to live up to their billing. In the absence of M

Sreeshankar, who had already qualified for Paris but will be unable to take part due to injury, Jeswin Aldrin is expected to represent the nation in men's long jump. He is the National Record-holder at 8.42m.

However, the 22-year-old from Tamil Nadu could only produce 7.99m on his way to the gold medal despite pleasant conditions.

In the women's event, an exciting contest was expected between the experienced Nayana James of Kerala and Uttar Pradesh's young Shaili Singh.

While Nayana had won the Indian Open in March with a PB of 6.67m, Shaili had clinched gold at IGP-1 in Bengaluru with 6.52m. Nayana (6.53m) defeated Shaili (6.34m) for the top spot on the podium in Bhubaneswar but to achieve 6.86m, the mark for Paris, both of them need to do much better.

Praveen Chithravel, the National Record-holder in men's triple jump at